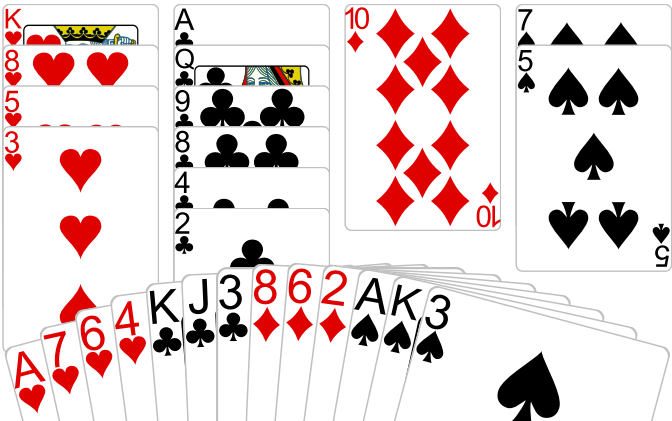
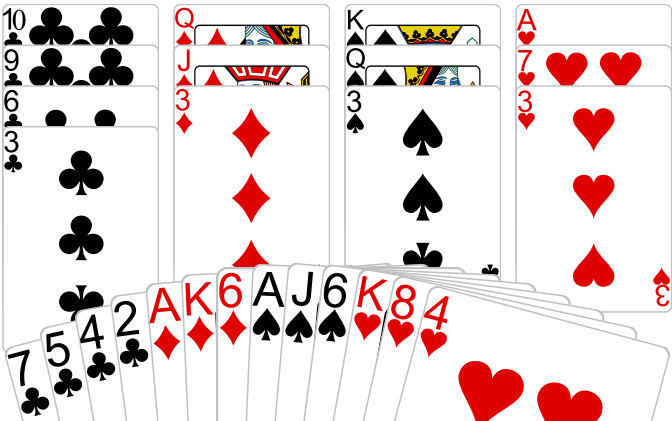


Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 4 2

♥ 10

♦ A 9 5 4 3

♣ 7 6

♠ A K 3

♥ A 7 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K J 3



♠ 9 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 10 5

♠ 7 5

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A Q 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦K. The ♦K holds the trick and East switches to the ♠9.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2/3

This looks like a walk in the park. Play 2 rounds of trumps, and if they split 3-2 go ahead and force the master trump out. The rest of the tricks would then be yours.

But West shows out on the second trump lead. Ouch!

**DO NOT PLAY ANOTHER TRUMP!** If you do, then East will pull all the trumps and then West/East will win some ♦s. Many, many ♦s.

Instead just start playing good ♣s. East can ruff in whenever he wants but you will maintain trump control. East can get both master trumps but nothing else.

It is usually correct to leave a master trump undrawn, just let the defender ruff in whenever he wants.

Here that principle applied even though there were **TWO** master trumps out.

Never mind trying to decide how to show the ♣ suit; with a 4-card Major your obligation is to use Stayman.

You say 2♣ and partner bids 2♥. What now?

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You say 2♣ and partner bids 2♥. What now?

Again, never mind the ♣ suit. You have an 8-card Major fit and enough points for game, so you bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3  
 ♥ A 7 3  
 ♦ Q J 3  
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ 8 5 2  
 ♥ Q 10 5 2  
 ♦ 9 7 4 2  
 ♣ K 8

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A J 6  
 ♥ K 8 4  
 ♦ A K 6  
 ♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ 10 9 7 4  
 ♥ J 9 6  
 ♦ 10 8 5  
 ♣ A Q J

|             |              |             |              |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|             |              | 1NT         | Pass         |

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

A defender will definitely win this, and probably continue ♠s (but if they switch you would play the same way). You win the ♠ and play another ♣.

South wins and plays another ♠; you win and play another ♣. Deja vu.

South wins again, cashed his established ♠, and exits with a red card. You win and claim the rest of the tricks, including your now-established ♣.

You were able to establish a ♣ because that suit split 3-2.

And you did it without going down because the ♠s split 4-3.

This may seem lucky to you, but don't knock it, it was your **ONLY** chance.

With 12 points and no 4-card Major suit this one is easy. You bid 3NT of course.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠10 and North follows with the ♠2.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 8

There is just no way your ninth winner can come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♦s. So by process of elimination you have to get a ♣ trick.

Win the first trick, probably in your hand, and play a ♣.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 3

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 3

♠ J 6 2

♥ A K J 6 4 2

♦ K

♣ J 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 9 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ A Q 5

♥ Q 10 9 3

♦ A J 10 7

♣ A 8

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass        | 2♦    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 5♠    |
| Pass        | 6♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by South |       |      |       |

Your partnership may play that a jump to 3♥ shows a 6-card suit with slam interest, in other words, this very hand. If you do, then bid it. If you don't, use a transfer first. Let's say you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 3♥. Now

Your partnership may play that a jump to 3♥ shows a 6-card suit with slam interest, in other words, this very hand. If you do, then bid it. If you don't, use a transfer first. Let's say you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 3♥. Now

You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least two Aces for his strong bidding. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and this is certainly not the type of hand where asking for Aces is always helpful - what if partner shows two Aces, aren't you going to bid the slam anyway? The advantage to Blackwood here is that there is just a slim possibility that partner has only one Ace!

You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♠. Next?

Your partnership may play that a jump to 3♥ shows a 6-card suit with slam interest, in other words, this very hand. If you do, then bid it. If you don't, use a transfer first. Let's say you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 3♥. Now You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least two Aces for his strong bidding. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and this is certainly not the type of hand where asking for Aces is always helpful - what if partner shows two Aces, aren't you going to bid the slam anyway? The advantage to Blackwood here is that there is just a slim possibility that partner has only one Ace! You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♠. Next? Three Aces. You still should stop at 6♥, based on points.

The contract would be 6♥ played by North.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♣10. You play the ♣J, just in case West made a mistake, but East puts on the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

The ♠ loser is deceptive. You could discard a ♠ from dummy on your ♦A, but would still have a ♠ loser if the finesse doesn't work. Still, this would be one possible plan. Can you improve on that?

Maybe you can. Look harder at the ♦s. Win the ♣A, then play to dummy's ♦K. Pull trumps (2 rounds) ending in your hand. Play your ♦A, but discard a ♣ from dummy, (the key play). Now play your ♦J, and if West plays low, discard dummy's other ♣.

You have gotten rid of the ♣ losers, but if East can win the ♦Q on this trick you will discard a ♠ on the ♦10, but will still have to try the ♠ finesse.

But, if the ♦J holds then it won't matter if the ♠ finesse works or not, you will make the slam.

Suppose when you play your ♦J West puts on the ♦Q.

No problem. You ruff in dummy, come back to your hand with a trump and **THEN** discard dummy's last ♣